Activity 3: Ritz-Carlton: Promise-to-Proof Service Blueprint

Objective: Apply organisation branding strategy to service standards and touchpoints
Expected output: Promise-to-proof architecture and service blueprint for four moments that matter Primary source: https://www.ritzcarlton.com/en/services/standards/

Goal

Use the Ritz-Carlton Gold Standards as a public reference for translating brand intent into observable delivery.

Real-world scenario

Ritz-Carlton publicly presents its Gold Standards-including its credo, motto and service values-as the foundation of its service culture.

A Singapore premium eldercare concierge has a warm visual identity but inconsistent enquiry, onboarding and family-update experiences. It wants standards that feel personal rather than scripted.

Evidence boundary

Public case facts and fictional learner data must never be mixed. Every numerical or organisational training input is labelled as an assumption.

Training assumptions / guardrails

- The eldercare concierge, personas and operational data are fictional and are not connected to Ritz-Carlton.
- Families value dignity, clarity, continuity and rapid escalation when care needs change.
- The organisation has 12 advisors across phone, WhatsApp and in-person channels.
- Privacy, safeguarding and clinical escalation are non-negotiable guardrails.

Questions

1. What strategic promise should the concierge make, and to whom?
2. Which service principles and observable standards would make the promise real?
3. Where should delivery be standardised, and where should employees exercise judgement?
4. What physical or digital evidence would reassure families before and during service?

Detailed activity procedure

Step 1: Extract the pattern

Study how the public Gold Standards connect purpose, values and service behaviour; do not copy protected brand language.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 2: Define positioning

Specify priority audience, frame of reference, valued difference and proof for the fictional concierge.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 3: Write the promise

Create a concise, relevant and deliverable promise, then translate it into three service principles.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 4: Map the journey

Select enquiry, onboarding, first week and exception handling as moments that matter.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 5: Build the blueprint

For each moment, document customer action, frontstage behaviour, backstage support, tangible evidence and metric.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 6: Set guardrails

Define non-negotiable outcomes, bounded personalisation, escalation triggers, owner and evidence of completion.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Deliverable

Promise-to-proof architecture and service blueprint for four moments that matter

Acceptance criteria

The blueprint traces one promise through principles, observable standards, backstage enablers, tangible cues and measures, with explicit privacy and safeguarding guardrails.

Reflection and debrief questions

1. Which customer or employee insight changed your recommendation most, and why?
2. What evidence would you request before investing or scaling?
3. Which stakeholder owns the next service-brand decision?
4. What should the organisation start, stop or continue?

Facilitator debrief

Compare recommendations against relevance, distinctiveness, deliverability and evidence quality. Surface unsupported causal claims. Close by naming one decision, one owner and one validation action.

Source note

Source accessed 17 August 2026: https://www.ritzcarlton.com/en/services/standards/